

DIGITAL PORTFOLIO / 2020 – PRESENT

Sole Exchange

How I built a sneaker resale brand on Instagram, turned attention into sales across eight channels, and kept buyers coming back.

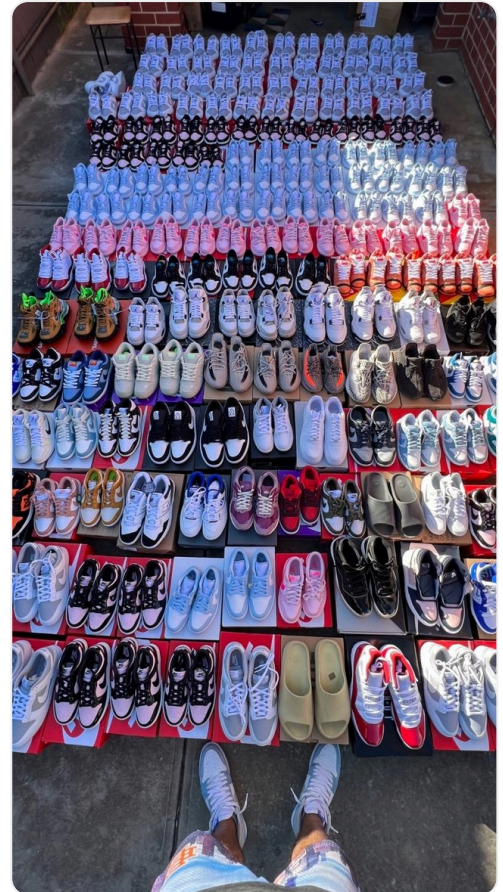
MY ROLE

Founder & marketing lead: Instagram, brand voice, content, customer DMs, sourcing, pricing and most day-to-day sales.

Co-founder: Shopify storefront, built with two collaborators. I led most of its marketing and conversion work.

AT A GLANCE

Sole Exchange ran at full scale from 2020 to 2024 and now trades occasionally. Instagram was where the brand lived; sales closed through Instagram DMs, Shopify and six other online and retail channels.



Part of the active inventory at peak: Dunks, Jordans and Yeezys.

5,000+ SALES	\$1M+ GROSS SALES (EST.)	8 SALES CHANNELS
5,979 PEAK WEEKLY ACCOUNTS REACHED	982 TOP POST INTERACTIONS	\$5,000 TOP SINGLE SALE

WHAT'S INSIDE

01 · Instagram & community: content pillars and the UGC playbook

02 · Case study: the giveaway campaign

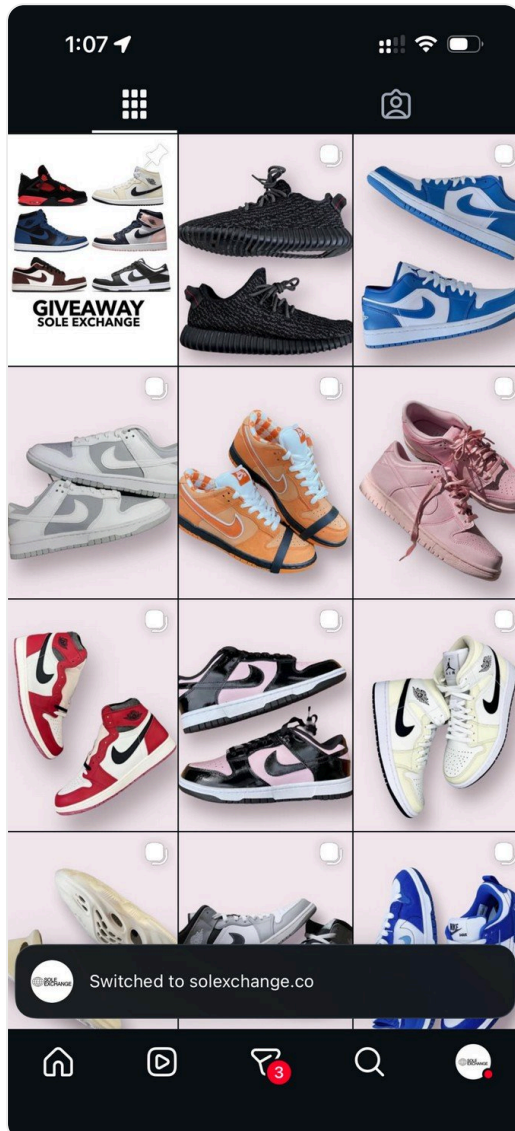
03 · Channels & pricing: Shopify, marketplaces and margin

04 · Results & reflections: outcomes, lessons, what I'd change

01 / INSTAGRAM & COMMUNITY

A small page with a high-intent audience.

The page never chased follower count. It ran on consistent product posts, fast replies and buyers' own content, and the 716 followers it built were people who actually bought sneakers.



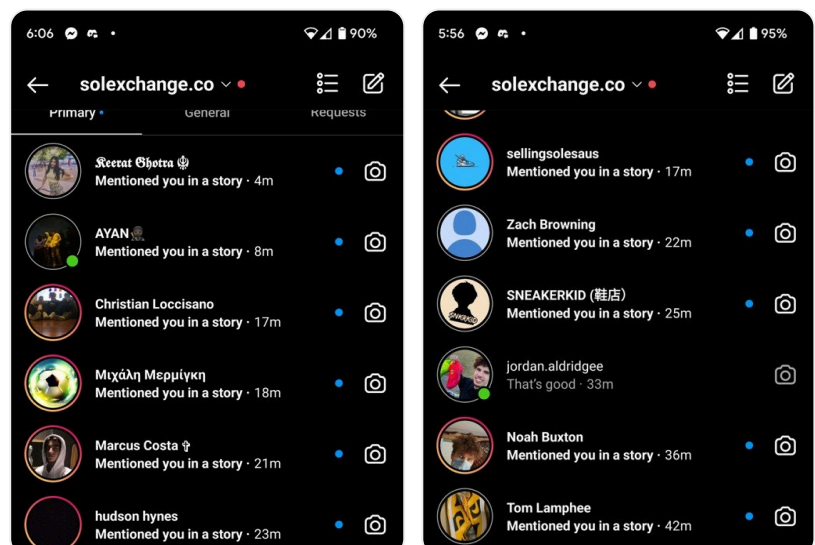
The grid: one visual language across every colourway.

CONTENT PILLARS

- **Product:** limited sneakers shot on a clean background.
- **Availability:** new arrivals and restocks announced in feed and stories.
- **Social proof:** reposted customer purchases and try-ons.
- **Engagement:** giveaways and prompts to drive comments and shares.

COMMUNITY PLAYBOOK

- **Repost cycle:** buyer story tags reposted to the brand's story, usually the same day.
- **Permanent proof:** a "Customers" highlight, so new visitors saw real buyers straight away.
- **1:1 response:** DMs answered personally within minutes, turning browsers into orders.
- **Discord:** a community channel for repeat buyers and referrals.



Customer story tags arriving within a single hour, all reposted as social proof.

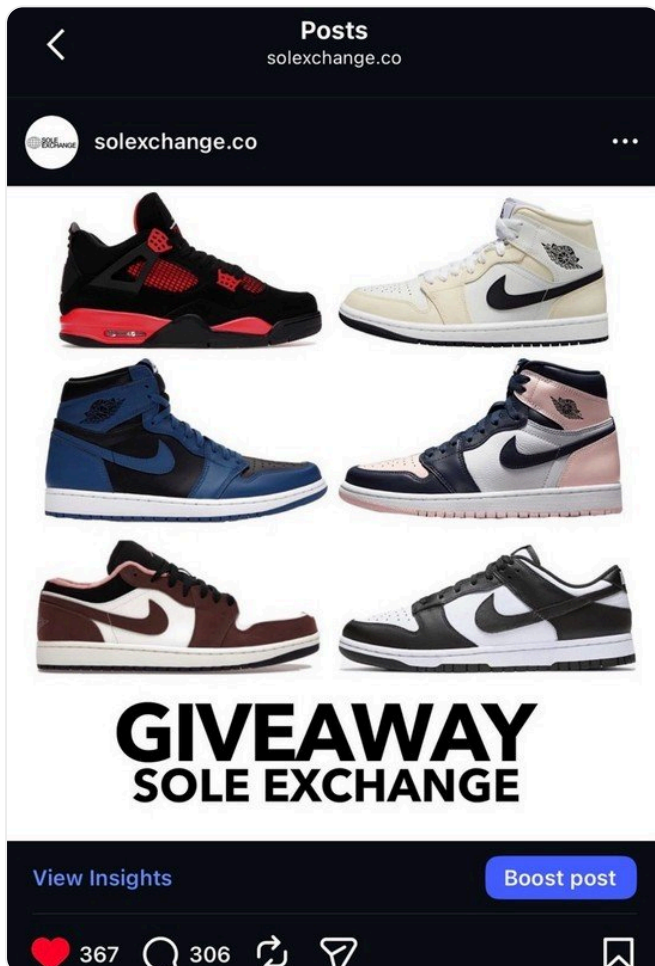
02 / CASE STUDY

One giveaway, 2.9× the follower base.

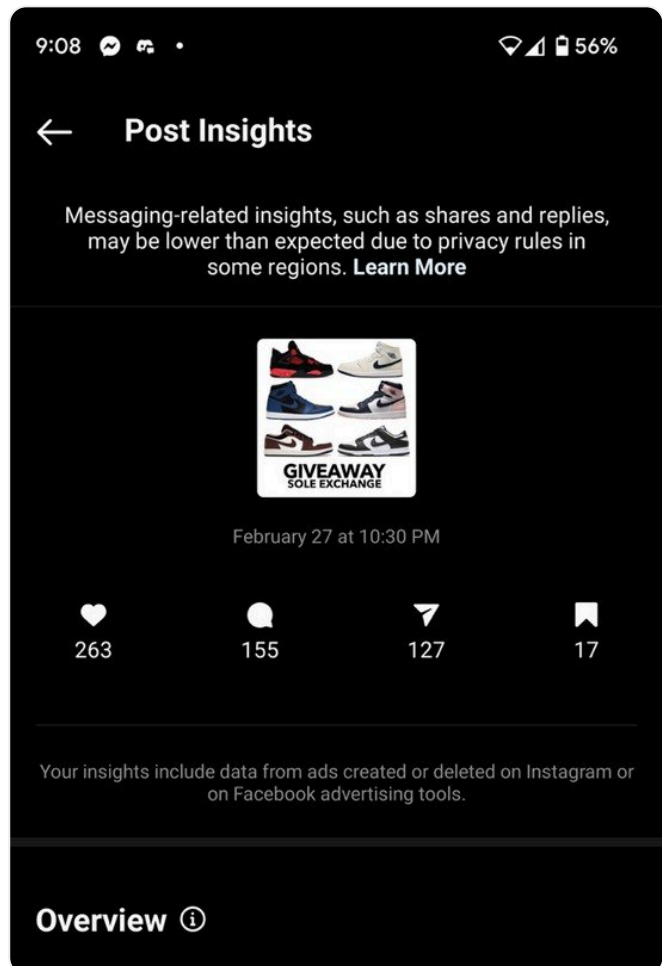
One giveaway became the page's best-performing post and put the brand in front of thousands of people who didn't follow it yet.

OBJECTIVE	ACTION	RESULT	LEARNING
Push reach beyond the 716 existing followers and bring new buyers to the page.	Six-sneaker giveaway (winner picks one). Entry meant liking, commenting, sharing and tagging friends.	591 reached in the first 24 hours, growing to 2,050 reached and 982 interactions. Most came from non-followers.	A real prize and a tag-to-enter mechanic beat standard product posts for reach and new-audience discovery.

2,050 REACHED	982 INTERACTIONS	648 PROFILE ACTIONS	367 LIKES	306 COMMENTS	157+ SHARES	30 SAVES
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The giveaway post: six sneakers, winner picks one.



24-hour Instagram Insights snapshot: 591 reached, 562 interactions.

03 / CHANNELS & PRICING

Eight channels, one pricing discipline.

Instagram created demand; the other channels widened reach and closed sales. Every listing was priced against the live market.

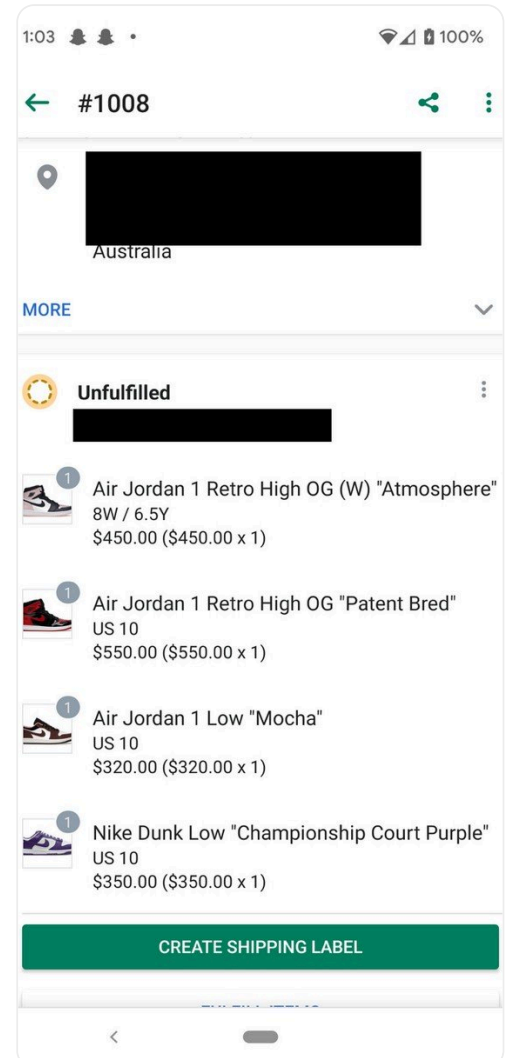
CHANNEL	ROLE IN THE FUNNEL
Instagram	Discovery, brand-building and 1:1 sales through DMs
Shopify	Direct checkout on a co-designed storefront with free shipping
StockX · GOAT (Alias)	Marketplace reach plus live resale price benchmarks
eBay · FB Marketplace	Broad and local reach for everyday pairs
Discord	Community, repeat buyers and referrals
Consignment	In-store retail exposure through a Melbourne sneaker store

PRICING APPROACH

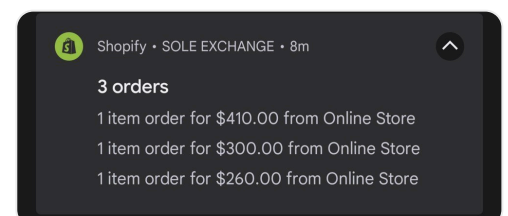
- **Market reference:** checked StockX and GOAT resale ceilings for every SKU before listing.
- **Timing:** held stock through hype cycles when StockX price history showed rising demand (e.g. University Blue, Travis Scott).
- **Friction:** free shipping on Shopify to compete with marketplaces that add costs at checkout.

WHAT KEPT SELLING

- **University Blue Jordans:** consistently strong, restocked repeatedly.
- **Panda Dunks:** the fastest-moving everyday colourway.
- **Travis Scott Jordan 1s:** highest margin. Top single sale: a Travis Scott Jordan 1 Low at around \$5,000.



Shopify order #1008: four pairs, \$1,670 in one basket. Customer details redacted.



Three Shopify orders inside eight minutes.

04 / RESULTS & REFLECTIONS

What it added up to.

- **Sales:** 5,000+ sales and an estimated \$1M+ in gross sales across eight channels.
- **Audience:** a 716-follower niche audience reaching up to 5,979 accounts a week; the top post drew interactions equal to 137% of the follower base.
- **Retention:** repeat and referral business through fast, personal DMs and Discord, including multi-pair Shopify baskets like the \$1,670 order.
- **E-commerce:** co-founded and co-designed the Shopify storefront and connected it to the Instagram funnel.

THREE LESSONS

01

The right audience beats a bigger one.

716 followers who wanted sneakers were worth more than a large audience that didn't buy.

02

Fast replies win sales.

Answering DMs in minutes turned casual interest into orders. In sneakers, whoever replies first usually gets the sale.

03

Price against the market.

Checking StockX and GOAT before every listing protected margin and avoided dead stock.

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

- **Own the audience:** capture buyers' emails at checkout and run a simple new-release email list, rather than relying on Instagram reach.
- **Measure from day one:** track traffic sources and conversion rate in Shopify and Google Analytics, so every channel's contribution is clear.
- **Retarget engaged audiences:** follow up giveaway entrants and profile visitors with a small paid social campaign to convert attention into first purchases.

MARKETING SKILLS DEMONSTRATED

Social media strategy

Content planning

Campaign execution & reporting

Community management

User-generated content

Social selling & DM conversion

Shopify

Multi-channel e-commerce

Pricing & market research

Product photography

Brand positioning

Customer service

Thanks for reading.

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